

13 YEAR TOPPERS

LAW

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi
2008	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi
2007	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLIU, Bhopal
2006	NLSIU, Bangalore	NALSAR, Hyderabad	NLIU, Bhopal
2005	ILS, Pune	NLSIU, Bangalore	Symbiosis Law College, Pune
2004	NLSIU, Bangalore	UCL, Bangalore	ILS, Pune
2003	NLSIU, Bangalore	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai	Faculty of Law, BHU, Varanasi
2002	NLSIU, Bangalore	ILS, Pune	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai
2001	NLSIU, Bangalore	UCL, Bangalore	Govt. College of Law, Mumbai
2000	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune
1999	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune
1998	NLSIU, Bangalore	Faculty of Law, DU, Delhi	Law College, Pune
1997	Law colleges were not ranked.		

ENGINEERING

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur
2008	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2007	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Chennai
2006	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2005	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Chennai
2004	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi	IIT, Mumbai
2003	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai
2002	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	BITS, Pilani
2001	IIT, Kharagpur	IIT, Kanpur	BITS, Pilani, IIT, Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai
2000	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Chennai	IIT, Delhi
1999	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Delhi
1998	IIT, Mumbai	IIT, Kanpur	IIT, Delhi
1997	IITs were excluded. IISc, Bangalore, Roorkee College of Engineering and Regional Engineering College, Tiruchirapalli, were top three.		

MEDICINE

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2008	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2007	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	CMC, Vellore
2006	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2005	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	SJMC, Bangalore
2004	AIIMS, Delhi	BMC, Bangalore	KMC, Manipal
2003	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
2002	CMC, Vellore	AIIMS, Delhi	JIPMER, Puducherry
2001	AIIMS, Delhi	AFMC, Pune	LHMC, Delhi
2000	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	AFMC, Pune
1999	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	JIPMER, Puducherry
1998	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	JIPMER, Puducherry
1997	AIIMS, Delhi	CMC, Vellore	JIPMER, Puducherry

streams—law and engineering—exhibit similar character traits. The National Law School of India University (NLSIU), Bangalore, which has regained its top slot, ensures that its faculty and students are constantly pushing the bar. “Vacations are out,” says R. Venkata Rao, NLSIU vice-chancellor, “and what is in is experimentation and innovation with the world being the benchmark.” The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi, which pushed aside competition from its IIT cousins elsewhere to retain primacy, works hard to keep abreast of the scientific community worldwide. Surendra Prasad, director, IIT, Delhi, says the institute is constantly updating its research infrastructure and this year it crossed the Rs 100-crore mark for funding such research.

All the toppers exhibit sterling qualities and have emerged as role models for others. But while there has been minor reshuffling of ranks among the Top 10 colleges in each of the streams this year, the big shifts have come in the so-called middle rankers. In the science stream, for instance, Delhi colleges Sri Venkateswara, Gargi and Ramjas, moved up smartly along with Mumbai's Sophia and Kolkata's Lady Brabourne. In the arts, Chennai's Women's Christian College made an impressive leap as did Delhi's Kamala Nehru. In commerce, Bangalore's Garden City College, Delhi's Jesus and Mary and Kolkata's Shri Shikshayatan made notable strides. The big message: performance does pay.

To ensure that the ranking process remains comprehensive, INDIA TODAY and The Nielsen Company have constantly strived to make improvements (see methodology). We have focused on enlarging the experts' base, making the sampling more robust and on eliminating any inadvertent biases. It is always a difficult process and is bound to cause heartburn to those who believed that they should have been rated more highly. For them we say, there is always next year. For the toppers, the advice is not to be complacent. As Australia realised in the current T20 World Cup series, the price they would have to pay could be very high. ■